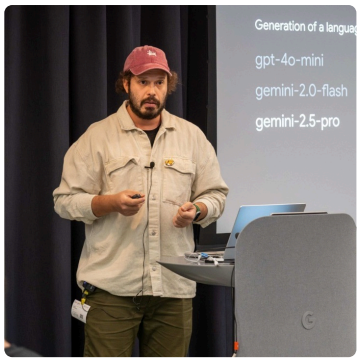
Vasil Kulakov

AI TRANSFORMATION & ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP | FORMER VP ENGINEERING & CTO | MBA

+49-178-268-90-16
vasily.kulakov@gmail.com
vasiliy.pro · linkedin.com/in/vasiliy-kulakov
Munich, Bavaria — available for hybrid presence in any city in Germany



MBA · **Google Professional Cloud Architect** · **Google Professional Cloud DevOps Engineer** · **EF SET English C2** — Proficient · **OKR Certification** — Objectives and Key Results

SUMMARY

Engineering leader (former VP of Engineering and CTO) with 20+ years in software and 14 years of people management, focused on AI transformation and agentic delivery — hands-on enough to validate the architecture, the code and the production model. MBA; Google Cloud Architect and DevOps certified. Based in Munich; available hybrid in any city in Germany.

- **AI-native delivery:** designed and run an operating model in which specialized agents execute scoped work through GitHub Issues, while product decisions, architecture, priorities, risk, review and acceptance stay human-owned.
- **Reliable AI platforms:** built a production AI language-learning platform load-tested at 20k RPS, and Keystone (KTMS), an open-source LLM gateway.
- **Engineering leadership:** scaled Homeapp engineering from 5 to ~40 people as VP of Engineering; stood up 3 product teams at Infourok.
- **Modernization & SRE:** led a six-month backend modernization and SRE transformation at CHECK24 (bare metal → Kubernetes), recognized with the internal Best Client-Oriented Product award.
- Languages: English (C2 / EF SET), German (B1).

RECOMMENDATIONS



"Committed to the goal even under a tight deadline — passionate about coding, with a calm, can-do attitude every company should be happy to have."
— Belma Herenda, Team Lead Software Developer, CHECK24 (worked with Vasil across teams)



"Exceptional as team lead and as a developer. He prioritised his team's well-being and was always willing to go the extra mile."
— Michael Erhard, Bereichsleiter, CHECK24 (managed Vasil directly)



"Under his leadership the department grew from 5 to 15. He took the product to MVP quickly and established Agile/Scrum and a full delivery lifecycle."
— Andrei Romashin, Frontend Engineer, Homeapp (reported to Vasil)



"An exceptional team leader who delivers high-quality projects on time and fosters a positive, inclusive team."
— Gergely Tőkési, Team Lead, CHECK24 (reported to Vasil)

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer
04/2026 – Present

vialytics — Munich, Bavaria, Germany · Remote

- Own function-critical grading services and their integration with Data Science products.

Founder & Engineering Lead
12/2024 – Present

Snappy Loop — Munich, Bavaria, Germany

- Designed a multi-agent delivery process: specialized agents execute scoped work through GitHub Issues; product decisions, architecture, priorities, risk, review and acceptance remain human-owned.
- Grew the AI language-learning product from 200 to 5,000 users in 3 months; evolved a single bot worker into a horizontally scalable, webhook-driven platform (Go, PHP, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kubernetes) load-tested at 20k RPS.
- Extracted the platform's LLM proxy into Keystone (KTMS), an open-source LLM gateway; presented the platform at SREday Munich 2026.

Engineering Manager
06/2023 – 12/2025

CHECK24 Vergleichsportal GmbH — Munich, Bavaria, Germany

- Led a six-month backend modernization (Laminas → Doctrine) together with an SRE transformation; recognized with the internal "Best Client-Oriented Product" award.
- Drove a DevOps/SRE transformation: Ansible on bare metal → Kubernetes, Helm, Bitbucket Pipelines; one-click test environments, observability, and CI with static analysis and tests.

Development Team Lead
08/2022 – 06/2023

CHECK24 Vergleichsportal GmbH — Munich, Bavaria, Germany

Team: 4 backend, 2 PMs.

- Led a 4-person backend team owning the delivery-tracking service; partnered with PMs on requirements, backlog, and architecture.
- Introduced Scrum; stabilized the legacy system and raised quality through code reviews and testing.

Head of Development
09/2021 – 08/2022

Infourok

Team: 12 backend, 5 frontend, 2 PMs, 2 designers.

- Built and managed 3 cross-functional product teams; set engineering workflow, automation, and architecture standards.

Vice President of Engineering
01/2019 – 09/2021

Homeapp

Team: 15 backend, 12 frontend, 5 QA, 4 DevOps, 4 PMs.

- Scaled engineering from 5 to ~40 people; introduced product trios across design, product, and engineering.
- Instituted Scrum, hiring, KPI/motivation, and remote operations; partnered with the CPO on product process.
- Built the company platform: microservices (PHP/Golang), Kubernetes, and CI/CD (JIRA, GitHub, Drone, Helm).

Engineering Manager
04/2018 – 01/2019

Homeapp

- Led frontend and backend engineers; introduced Docker, GKE continuous delivery, and CI.

KYC Lead Developer
04/2017 – 04/2018

Balance Platform

- Led KYC delivery on a cloud banking product; introduced Scrum and Docker-based CI (tests ~10× faster).

Engineering Manager
08/2015 – 04/2017

Digital Society Laboratory

- Led 3 engineers and owned architecture on a high-pace Symfony project.

Engineering Manager
09/2014 – 08/2015

Bumble Inc. — London Area, United Kingdom

- Led an international release-engineering team in London across time zones; automated and owned the end-to-end release cycle with Product.

CTO
03/2012 – 09/2014

Creara Media

- Led the engineering department: 5 PHP teams (15 developers); introduced Git/Jira/TeamCity CI/CD, owned technology choices and shared platform components.

Engineering Manager
11/2010 – 03/2012

Creara Media

- Led billing delivery and people development; helped design company-wide CI/CD.

Web Development Consultant
01/2010 – 11/2011

MOST Creative Club

- Advised the web department on delivery and engineering practices.

Head of IT
01/2005 – 10/2010

Sbubnom web-studio — Moscow, Russia

- Managed 3 teams (12 developers); delivered ~20 promo projects.

Engineering Manager (Contract)
05/2010 – 09/2010

Pernod Ricard

- Delivered IT systems for an interactive promo project.

Engineering Manager (Contract)
02/2010 – 07/2010

Samsonite

- Delivered IT systems for an interactive promo project.

Engineering Manager (Contract)
04/2009 – 08/2009

Renault

- Delivered dealership hardware and a UGC site for a new-model promo campaign.

CERTIFICATES

- **Google Professional Cloud Architect** — Jun 2025, valid until Jun 2027
- **Google Professional Cloud DevOps Engineer** — Apr 2025, valid until Apr 2027
- **EF SET English Certificate (C2 Proficient)** — Dec 2024
- **Objectives and Key Results — OKRs** — Dec 2024
- **Zend Certified Engineer** — Jun 2015
- **IBM EServer Technology Solutions** — Nov 2011

EDUCATION

MBA
2007 – 2010

Engineer — Computer systems and networks
National Research Nuclear University MEPhI
2004 – 2009

TALKS & OPEN SOURCE

- One Bot, One Pod, One Problem at a Time — SREday Munich, May 2026
- Stop Prototyping, Start Shipping — meetup at Google, December 2025
- github.com/ai-process/ktms — Keystone (KTMS), open-source LLM gateway
- telegraph-go/telegraph · deckwatch/deckwatch-go